PRACTITIONER REFERENCE

Contraindication Cheat Sheet

A quick screen, not a diagnosis. When in doubt, don't treat and ask for written medical clearance.

KEY **No** Do not treat **Wait [time]** Postpone *Caution* Modify or get clearance OK Fine after screening

IF CLIENT HAS	Facial	Extrac-tions	Peel	Derma-plane	Micro-needle	Wax	LED	Micro-current	Lash / brow tint
MEDICATIONS									
Isotretinoin [1]	*Caution*	*Caution*	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	**Wait 6 mo**	OK	OK	*Caution*
Rx retinoids [2]	*Caution*	*Caution*	**Wait 1 wk**	**Wait 1 wk**	**Wait 1 wk**	**Wait 1 wk**	OK	OK	OK
Retinol, AHA/BHA [2]	OK	OK	**Wait 1 wk**	**Wait 1 wk**	**Wait 1 wk**	**Wait 1 wk**	OK	OK	OK
Blood thinners [3]	OK	*Caution*	*Caution*	**No**	**No**	*Caution*	OK	OK	OK
Photosensitizers [11]	OK	OK	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	OK
HEALTH & CONDITIONS									
Pregnant or nursing [4]	OK	OK	*Caution*	OK	**No**	*Caution*	*Caution*	**No**	*Caution*
Cold sore, active	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Cold sore history [5]	OK	OK	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	OK	OK
Pacemaker, implants [6]	*Caution*	OK	OK	OK	*Caution*	OK	OK	**No**	OK
Epilepsy, seizures [6]	*Caution*	OK	OK	OK	OK	OK	*Caution*	**No**	OK
Diabetes [7]	OK	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	OK	OK
Autoimmune, skin flare	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	**No**	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	*Caution*
Keloid scarring	OK	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	**No**	*Caution*	OK	OK	OK
Skin cancer, mole [8]	*Caution*	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
RECENT TREATMENTS & SKIN STATE									
Botox, past 2 wk [9]	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	*Caution*	**Wait 2 wk**	OK
Filler, past 2 wk [9]	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	*Caution*	**Wait 2 wk**	OK
Laser or peel, past 2 wk	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	OK	*Caution*	OK
Sunburn, fresh tan	*Caution*	*Caution*	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**Wait 2 wk**	**No**	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK
Infection, rash [10]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**

[1] Taking now or in the past 6 months. Some brands ask 12; a 2017 expert panel found little evidence to delay superficial peels.

[2] Stop 5–7 days before; restart once skin is fully calm. Skin lifting risk with wax.

[3] Incl. daily aspirin. Never advise stopping a prescribed medicine.

[4] No retinoid or salicylic peels and no electrical currents.

[5] Suggest asking their doctor about an antiviral first.

[6] No galvanic, high frequency or microcurrent. No flashing or pulsed LED modes.

[7] Slow healing. Treat only if well controlled.

[8] Never treat over a lesion. Refer changing moles.

[9] No pressure or devices over injected areas, or follow the injector.

[10] Reschedule; refer to a physician if it looks infected.

[11] e.g. doxycycline and other tetracyclines, some diuretics, St. John's wort. Lower intensity, patch test, strict SPF.

Conservative defaults. Sources disagree on many windows, so this sheet uses the more cautious one. Your state board's scope, the product or device maker's instructions and the client's physician always come first. Review it yearly.